

AKOIN FINTECH PRIVATE LIMITED

**Assignment: Security Governance, Risk &
Compliance (GRC) Professional Development
Programme for Security Managers**

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1. Introduction

Organizations today operate in an environment where cybersecurity is no longer limited to technical controls and operational security practices. Businesses in sectors such as finance, healthcare, government, and critical infrastructure must comply with strict regulatory requirements and adopt enterprise risk management practices to protect sensitive data, maintain trust, and ensure business continuity.

Security managers often possess strong technical and operational capabilities in areas such as network security, incident response, and vulnerability management. However, many lack formal training in governance, regulatory compliance, and enterprise risk management (ERM). This gap creates challenges in aligning security initiatives with organizational strategy and regulatory obligations.

This professional development programme has been designed to address this gap by equipping security managers with the knowledge and skills required to integrate governance, risk, and compliance (GRC) principles into practical security decision-making.

1.1 Background of the Study

Over the past decade, the cybersecurity landscape has evolved significantly due to the rapid growth of digital transformation, cloud computing, remote work, and global connectivity. As organizations increasingly rely on digital systems, regulatory bodies have introduced strict standards and frameworks such as ISO 27001, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), GDPR, PCI-DSS, and SOC 2 to ensure the protection of sensitive information and critical systems.

These frameworks emphasize risk management, governance, accountability, and compliance. Organizations are now expected to demonstrate that their security controls are not only technically effective but also aligned with legal, regulatory, and business requirements.

Despite this shift, many security managers continue to focus primarily on operational and technical aspects of security. As a result, there is a growing need for structured training that bridges the gap between technical security expertise and governance and risk management competencies.

1.2 Problem Statement

Security managers in many organizations possess strong operational knowledge of physical and digital security practices. However, they often lack a clear understanding of regulatory frameworks, compliance requirements, and enterprise risk management processes.

This knowledge gap can lead to:

- Misalignment between security controls and business objectives
- Difficulty in prioritizing security investments based on risk

- Ineffective communication with executive leadership and regulators
- Increased likelihood of audit failures and regulatory penalties
- Weak integration of security into organizational governance structures

Without proper training in governance and risk management, organizations face challenges in building security programmes that are both effective and compliant.

1.3 Purpose of the Programme

The purpose of this programme is to provide security managers with a structured learning pathway that enhances their understanding of governance, risk management, and regulatory compliance.

The programme aims to:

- Bridge the gap between technical security and business governance
- Enable risk-based decision-making in security operations
- Improve audit readiness and compliance capabilities
- Support alignment between security initiatives and organizational strategy
- Develop leadership and communication skills for regulated environments

Ultimately, the programme seeks to transform technically skilled security professionals into well-rounded security leaders capable of operating in highly regulated environments.

1.4 Scope of the Programme

The programme focuses on the integration of governance, risk, and compliance principles into security management practices. The scope includes:

- Understanding major regulatory and security frameworks
- Applying enterprise risk management to security planning
- Mapping compliance requirements to security controls
- Developing policies, procedures, and reporting mechanisms
- Managing incidents within legal and regulatory contexts
- Addressing third-party and supply chain security risks
- Enhancing communication with executive and regulatory stakeholders

The programme does not focus on deep technical security implementation; instead, it emphasizes strategic, managerial, and compliance-driven aspects of security.

1.5 Target Audience

This programme is intended for professionals who have technical security experience but limited exposure to governance and risk management concepts.

The target audience includes:

- Security Managers and Team Leads

- SOC Managers and Senior Analysts
- IT Security Professionals transitioning into leadership roles
- Infrastructure and Operations Security Managers
- Professionals preparing for governance, risk, or compliance roles

Participants are expected to have a foundational understanding of cybersecurity concepts and practical security operations.

2. Programme Overview

The Security Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC) Professional Development Programme helps security managers expand beyond technical security and understand how governance, risk management, and compliance support business success. The programme focuses on aligning security practices with organizational goals and regulatory requirements.

2.1 Programme Aim

The aim of the programme is to prepare security managers to apply GRC principles in real-world decision-making and strategic security planning.

Participants will be able to:

- Understand the role of governance in security programmes.
- Apply risk-based thinking in security planning.
- Align security initiatives with business and regulatory needs.

2.2 Programme Objectives

This programme is designed to build practical knowledge and professional skills needed in regulated environments.

Participants will:

- Gain awareness of major security and regulatory frameworks.
- Learn enterprise risk management fundamentals.
- Improve compliance and audit readiness.
- Develop reporting and communication skills.
- Support strategic security planning.

2.3 Expected Impact on Organizations

Organizations will benefit from stronger alignment between security, risk, and business strategy. The programme supports improved decision-making and long-term resilience.

Key benefits include:

- Better compliance and reduced regulatory risk.
- Improved risk prioritization and security investment planning.
- Stronger communication between security teams and leadership.
- Enhanced incident response and organizational resilience.

3. Learning Outcomes

After completing the Security Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC) Professional Development Programme, participants will gain advanced knowledge and practical competencies to integrate governance, regulatory compliance, and enterprise risk management into real-world security operations. The programme emphasizes strategic thinking, business alignment, and regulatory awareness to prepare participants for leadership roles in regulated environments.

3.1 Regulatory Knowledge & Compliance

Participants will develop an in-depth understanding of global cybersecurity and privacy regulations and how they influence organizational security strategies. They will learn how compliance supports trust, legal protection, and business continuity.

Participants will be able to:

- Understand the objectives and structure of major frameworks:
 1. ISO 27001 Information Security Management System (ISMS)
 2. NIST Cybersecurity Framework (Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, Recover)
 3. GDPR data protection and privacy principle
 4. PCI-DSS requirements for payment security
 5. SOC 2 Trust Services Criteria
- Translate regulatory requirements into practical organizational controls.
- Recognize the relationship between compliance and risk management.
- Understand penalties and business impacts of regulatory violations.
- Identify cross-framework common controls and overlapping requirements.

Practical Application:

Participants will be able to review an organization's security programme and determine whether it aligns with relevant regulatory requirements.

3.2 Security Governance Understanding

Participants will gain a strong understanding of governance structures and their role in aligning security with organizational strategy and leadership expectations.

Participants will be able to:

- Understand governance roles including board, executives, risk committees, and security teams.
- Develop and maintain:
 1. Security policies
 2. Standards and procedures
 3. Acceptable use and access control policies

- Establish accountability and reporting structures.
- Align security initiatives with business objectives and strategic goals.
- Promote a culture of security awareness and responsibility.

Practical Application:

Participants will be able to design a governance model for a security programme.

3.3 Enterprise Risk Management Skills

Participants will learn how security risks fit into the broader enterprise risk landscape.

Participants will be able to:

- Identify different types of risks:
 1. Operational risk
 2. Strategic risk
 3. Financial risk
 4. Compliance risk
 5. Cybersecurity risk
- Conduct risk assessments using:
 1. Risk matrices
 2. Likelihood vs impact analysis
 3. Risk scoring methods
- Understand risk treatment strategies:
 1. Risk mitigation
 2. Risk transfer
 3. Risk acceptance
 4. Risk avoidance
- Maintain and update risk registers.

Practical Application:

Participants will be able to perform a complete security risk assessment.

3.4 Risk-Based Decision Making

This outcome focuses on using risk as the foundation for planning, budgeting, and prioritization.

Participants will be able to:

- Define and apply:
 1. Risk appetite

2. Risk tolerance
3. Risk thresholds

- Evaluate cost vs risk reduction of security controls.
- Prioritize security initiatives based on business impact.
- Justify security investments to leadership.
- Support budgeting and resource allocation decisions.

Practical Application:

Participants will be able to recommend security investments based on risk analysis.

3.5 Compliance Implementation & Audit Readiness

Participants will gain practical knowledge of implementing and maintaining compliance programmes.

Participants will be able to:

- Map security controls to regulatory requirements.
- Conduct compliance gap assessments.
- Prepare documentation and evidence for audits:
 1. Policies and procedures
 2. Risk assessments
 3. Logs and monitoring records
 4. Training and awareness records
- Support internal and external audits.
- Maintain continuous compliance monitoring.

Practical Application:

Participants will be able to prepare an organization for a compliance audit.

3.6 Security Metrics & Reporting

Participants will learn how to measure security effectiveness and communicate performance to stakeholders.

Participants will be able to:

- Develop:
 1. Key Risk Indicators (KRIs)
 2. Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)
- Build dashboards and executive reports.
- Track compliance status and risk trends.
- Communicate security posture to leadership.
- Support data-driven decision making.

Practical Application:

Participants will be able to design a security reporting dashboard.

3.7 Incident Response in Regulated Environments

Participants will learn how incident response must align with legal and regulatory requirements.

Participants will be able to:

- Understand breach notification timelines and legal obligations.
- Align incident response plans with compliance requirements.
- Coordinate with:
 1. Legal teams
 2. Compliance teams
 3. Public relations teams
 4. Executive leadership
- Conduct post-incident reviews and lessons learned.
- Improve incident response readiness.

Practical Application:

Participants will be able to develop a compliance-aligned incident response plan.

3.8 Third-Party & Supply Chain Risk Management

Participants will learn how external vendors can introduce significant security and compliance risks.

Participants will be able to:

- Perform vendor risk assessments.
- Define security requirements in contracts and agreements.
- Monitor third-party compliance and performance.
- Identify risks from outsourcing and cloud services.
- Integrate third-party risks into enterprise risk management.

Practical Application:

Participants will be able to design a vendor risk management programme.

3.9 Strategic Security Leadership

Participants will develop leadership skills required for senior security roles.

Participants will be able to:

- Communicate risks and strategies to executives and boards.
- Align security strategy with business objectives.

- Build cross-functional collaboration between departments.
- Promote security as a business enabler.
- Support long-term strategic planning.

Practical Application:

Participants will be able to present a strategic security roadmap to leadership.

4. Conclusion

The Security Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC) Professional Development Programme is designed to bridge the gap between technical security expertise and the governance and risk management capabilities required in modern organizations. As regulatory requirements continue to grow, security managers must develop the ability to align security practices with business objectives, compliance obligations, and enterprise risk management.

This programme provides a structured pathway to help security professionals transition into strategic roles by strengthening their understanding of regulatory frameworks, risk-based decision-making, and security leadership.

In summary, the programme:

- Enhances understanding of regulatory and compliance requirements.
- Promotes risk-based security planning and decision-making.
- Improves audit readiness and incident response capabilities.
- Strengthens communication between security teams and leadership.
- Supports long-term organizational resilience and governance maturity.

By completing this programme, security managers will be better prepared to lead security initiatives in regulated environments and contribute to the overall success and resilience of their organizations.